INT. DARK ROOM - NIGHT

The room is swallowed by shadows. KELLY (20) and JESS (20) sit cross-legged on the floor, hunched over eighteen poker cards laid out in a precise grid.

KELLY
(a harsh whisper)
Shhhh! It’s your turn now.

Jess stares at the cards. She looks at Kelly, who is vibrating with a mix of excitement and "ghoul game" intensity.

JESS
(to herself)
Is this game bull?

Jess hovers her hand over the cards, one by one. Her palm passes over the cardboard.

JESS (cont’d)
What am I even supposed to be feeling again?

KELLY
You should feel heat coming from a card. Then you flip it. The suit tells you the answer.

Jess continues to hover. Her arm begins to shake from the effort.

JESS
I give up. My hand is just tired.

Kelly’s grin fades for a split second, then returns, wider and sharper than before. She reaches out.

KELLY
Fine, I’ll try.

Kelly hovers her hand for barely three seconds

She doesn’t hesitate

She flips a card

THE TWO OF HEARTS.

Kelly slides her laptop across the floor. The screen glows: Ghostinmymachine.com.

HEART = YES SPADE = NO DIAMOND = MAYBE CLUB = I DON’T KNOW

KELLY (cont'd)
Is Jess adopted?

Jess freezes.

Kelly doesn't know the truth, but the card is face up between them.

KELLY (cont'd)
I can't believe it. It's a "Yes." Is that true?

JESS
NO!

Jess lunges forward.

She hovers her hand over the grid curious.

JESS (cont'd)
Is Kelly's dad cheating on her mom?

Jess knows the answer, she's the one he's doing it with. She expects nothing, but then, a tingle. Not heat, but a sharp electric prickle against her palm. She moves her hand away, then brings it back. The tingle returns.

She flips it

A DIAMOND

Maybe

KELLY
(Voice trembling)
Is my dad cheating on my mom?

Kelly hovers for five long seconds

Her hand drops

She flips

THE ACE OF HEARTS.

KELLY (cont'd)
What! I don't want to play this anymore!

Kelly tries to pull back, but Jess is already hovering again, her eyes fixed on the cards.

JESS
Is it me he is cheating with?

Jess flips.

A DIAMOND.

JESS (cont'd)
Is there more than one?

Jess doesn't even wait to feel the heat this time.

She flips a card at random.

A HEART.

Kelly stares at Jess.

KELLY
Is Jess a slut?

Kelly flips a card instantly.

A HEART.